

A NEW TAIL

Some lizards can detach their tails to escape from or deter a predator. After the tail has fallen off, the area heals like a wound. After about ten days a new tail begins to grow.

A LIZARD'S DETACHED TAIL GOES ON MOVING FOR A WHILE TO DISTRACT THE PREDATOR



1 TAIL FALLS OFF
The lizard detaches the end of its tail when attacked or threatened. The point of breakage begins to heal.

2 GROWING BACK
Within 10 days or so, a new tail starts growing. By about day 25, the new tail is strong enough for the lizard to flick it.

3 NEW FOR OLD
After about 60 days, the new tail is complete. It is not exactly the same as the original tail, as it uses cartilage instead of bone.

SIZE COMPARISON

The world's smallest lizard fits on a fingernail. The biggest weighs about 70 kg (154 lb) and can hunt down large animals.



BRITISH VIRGIN ISLAND DWARF GECKO
18 mm (0.75 in) long

KOMODO DRAGON
3.1 m (10 ft) long

CHAMELEONS

Chameleons mainly live in trees. They have long tongues for catching insects and protruding eyes that move independently of one another. The chameleon can swivel each eye around to look at two different things at once.



JACKSON'S CHAMELEON

MEDITERRANEAN CHAMELEON

COLOUR CHANGE

Chameleons have special skin cells containing tiny sacs of different coloured pigments. The lizard's moods – such as anger and fear – cause changes in its body that trigger the release of colour from the sacs.



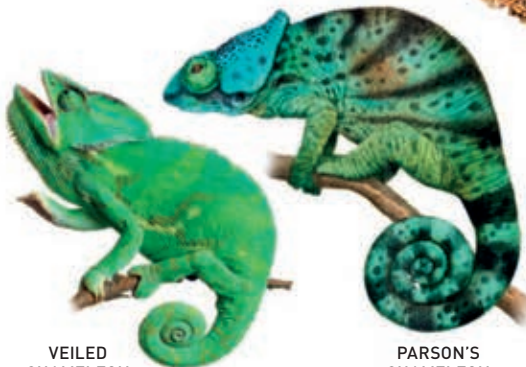
PANTHER CHAMELEON

A calm chameleon is usually a pale green colour. When it wants to show off to a possible mate, the chameleon may display all sorts of colours at once.

Protruding eyes that move in different directions



GIANT SPINY CHAMELEON



VEILED CHAMELEON

PARSON'S CHAMELEON

Two groups of toes on each foot help the chameleon hang on to the branch

PANTHER CHAMELEON

LEGLESS LIZARDS

These lizards look like snakes, but can be distinguished from them by several features. Unlike snakes, they have eyelids, external ear openings, and a tail that can break off if the lizard is attacked by a predator.



SLOW WORM



EUROPEAN GLASS LIZARD



SLENDER GLASS LIZARD

SKINKS

Skinks have very long, rounded bodies and pointed heads. Their legs are short, or even absent, and they like to burrow into soft, sandy ground. They eat snails, slugs, and insects.



FIVE-LINED SKINK

SANDFISH SKINK

PERCIVAL'S LANCE SKINK

FIRE SKINK

OTHER LIZARDS

There are many types of lizards. Some are small families, such as the seven tegu species, while others are large, such as the 391 species of anole lizards.



KNIGHT ANOLE

GREEN ANOLE

THAI WATER DRAGON

FRILLED LIZARD

RED TEGU